

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 9 4
 ♥ 7 5 3
 ♦ Q 10 9 2
 ♣ 9 4

♠ K 8 2

♥ A K

♦ A 8 5 3

♣ A Q 8 7



♠ A 10 7
 ♥ Q J 10 9
 ♦ J 7 4
 ♣ 10 6 3

♠ 6 5 3

♥ 8 6 4 2

♦ K 6

♣ K J 5 2

West	North	East	South
Pass	2NT	Pass	3♣
Pass	3♦	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by North

Welcome to the real world.

North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♥Q.

Winners: ♠=0 ♥=2 ♦=2 ♣=4 Total = 8

Needing one more winner you should see right away that it cannot come from ♥s, ♦s, or ♣s. That means you must hope that West has the ♠A. Win the first ♥, then play your 4 ♣ winners ending in dummy.

The moment of truth. You lead a small ♠ from dummy. West plays low and you play the ♠K.

Unfortunately East takes your ♠K with the ♠A. He then plays another ♥ and you at least make 8 tricks but have no hope for a ninth one so you go down 1.

You probably thought since these Deals were all about finesses that they would work all of the time.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 8 6 2
 ♥ 8 4 3 2
 ♦ A Q 7 4
 ♣ 9 5

♠ J 10 5

♥ A 6

♦ J 9 3 2

♣ A 8 6 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 7 4

♥ K Q J 9 7 5

♦ 8

♣ K Q J

♠ K Q 9 3

♥ 10

♦ K 10 6 5

♣ 10 7 3 2

West

North

East

South

2♥

Pass

4♥

Pass

All Pass

4♥ by East

At this point you have not lost any tricks, and you can see that you have only 3 losers remaining in your hand. So you start pulling trumps and establishing the ♣s.

If the ♦ finesse had lost you would have gone down 2 instead of just one.

The risk was worthwhile though since it gave you your only chance of making the contract.

East is to play 4♥. South leads the ♠K.

Losers: ♠=2 ♥=1 ♦=0 ♣=1 Total = 4

South found the best opening lead for his side, exposing your ♠ losers before you could establish the ♣ suit for a discard. If you start to pull trumps right away the defense will grab the ♥A, then take their two ♠ tricks and you will still have the ♣A that you cannot avoid.

Other than the ♦A the only useful card in dummy is the ♦Q so you must try to make a winner out of that for a discard. So win the ♠A, lead your singleton ♦ and finesse the ♦Q. Your luck has returned, the ♦Q wins and you discard one of your ♠ losers on the ♦A.

Board 3

South Deals
E-W Vul

♠ Q J 9 4
♥ 7 5 3
♦ Q 10 9 2
♣ 9 4

♠ K 8 2
♥ A K
♦ A 8 5 3
♣ A Q 8 7



♠ A 10 7
♥ Q J 10 9
♦ J 7 4
♣ 10 6 3

♠ 6 5 3
♥ 8 6 4 2
♦ K 6
♣ K J 5 2

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ 8 6 2

♥ 8 4 3 2

♦ A Q 7 4

♣ 9 5

♠ J 10 5

♥ A 6

♦ J 9 3 2

♣ A 8 6 4



♠ A 7 4

♥ K Q J 9 7 5

♦ 8

♣ K Q J

♠ K Q 9 3

♥ 10

♦ K 10 6 5

♣ 10 7 3 2

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q J 9 4
♥ 7 5 3
♦ Q 10 9 2
♣ 9 4

♠ K 8 2
♥ A K
♦ A 8 5 3
♣ A Q 8 7



♠ A 10 7
♥ Q J 10 9
♦ J 7 4
♣ 10 6 3

♠ 6 5 3
♥ 8 6 4 2
♦ K 6
♣ K J 5 2

Board 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 8 6 2
♥ 8 4 3 2
♦ A Q 7 4
♣ 9 5

♠ J 10 5
♥ A 6
♦ J 9 3 2
♣ A 8 6 4



♠ A 7 4
♥ K Q J 9 7 5
♦ 8
♣ K Q J

♠ K Q 9 3
♥ 10
♦ K 10 6 5
♣ 10 7 3 2

Board 7

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q J 9 4

♥ 7 5 3

♦ Q 10 9 2

♣ 9 4

♠ K 8 2

♥ A K

♦ A 8 5 3

♣ A Q 8 7



♠ A 10 7

♥ Q J 10 9

♦ J 7 4

♣ 10 6 3

♠ 6 5 3

♥ 8 6 4 2

♦ K 6

♣ K J 5 2

Board 8

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 6 2
♥ 8 4 3 2
♦ A Q 7 4
♣ 9 5

♠ J 10 5

♥ A 6

♦ J 9 3 2

♣ A 8 6 4



♠ A 7 4

♥ K Q J 9 7 5

♦ 8

♣ K Q J

♠ K Q 9 3

♥ 10

♦ K 10 6 5

♣ 10 7 3 2

Board 9

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q J 9 4
♥ 7 5 3
♦ Q 10 9 2
♣ 9 4

♠ K 8 2
♥ A K
♦ A 8 5 3
♣ A Q 8 7



♠ A 10 7
♥ Q J 10 9
♦ J 7 4
♣ 10 6 3

♠ 6 5 3
♥ 8 6 4 2
♦ K 6
♣ K J 5 2

Board 10

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ 8 6 2

♥ 8 4 3 2

♦ A Q 7 4

♣ 9 5

♠ J 10 5

♥ A 6

♦ J 9 3 2

♣ A 8 6 4



♠ A 7 4

♥ K Q J 9 7 5

♦ 8

♣ K Q J

♠ K Q 9 3

♥ 10

♦ K 10 6 5

♣ 10 7 3 2

Board 11

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 9 4
♥ 7 5 3
♦ Q 10 9 2
♣ 9 4

♠ K 8 2
♥ A K
♦ A 8 5 3
♣ A Q 8 7



♠ A 10 7
♥ Q J 10 9
♦ J 7 4
♣ 10 6 3

♠ 6 5 3
♥ 8 6 4 2
♦ K 6
♣ K J 5 2

Board 12

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 8 6 2
♥ 8 4 3 2
♦ A Q 7 4
♣ 9 5

♠ J 10 5

♥ A 6

♦ J 9 3 2

♣ A 8 6 4



♠ A 7 4

♥ K Q J 9 7 5

♦ 8

♣ K Q J

♠ K Q 9 3

♥ 10

♦ K 10 6 5

♣ 10 7 3 2

Board 13

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q J 9 4
♥ 7 5 3
♦ Q 10 9 2
♣ 9 4

♠ K 8 2
♥ A K
♦ A 8 5 3
♣ A Q 8 7



♠ A 10 7
♥ Q J 10 9
♦ J 7 4
♣ 10 6 3

♠ 6 5 3
♥ 8 6 4 2
♦ K 6
♣ K J 5 2

Board 14

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 6 2

♥ 8 4 3 2

♦ A Q 7 4

♣ 9 5

♠ J 10 5

♥ A 6

♦ J 9 3 2

♣ A 8 6 4



♠ A 7 4

♥ K Q J 9 7 5

♦ 8

♣ K Q J

♠ K Q 9 3

♥ 10

♦ K 10 6 5

♣ 10 7 3 2

Board 15

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q J 9 4
♥ 7 5 3
♦ Q 10 9 2
♣ 9 4

♠ K 8 2
♥ A K
♦ A 8 5 3
♣ A Q 8 7



♠ A 10 7
♥ Q J 10 9
♦ J 7 4
♣ 10 6 3

♠ 6 5 3
♥ 8 6 4 2
♦ K 6
♣ K J 5 2

Board 16

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 8 6 2
♥ 8 4 3 2
♦ A Q 7 4
♣ 9 5

♠ J 10 5

♥ A 6

♦ J 9 3 2

♣ A 8 6 4



♠ A 7 4

♥ K Q J 9 7 5

♦ 8

♣ K Q J

♠ K Q 9 3

♥ 10

♦ K 10 6 5

♣ 10 7 3 2

Board 17

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 9 4
♥ 7 5 3
♦ Q 10 9 2
♣ 9 4

♠ K 8 2

♥ A K

♦ A 8 5 3

♣ A Q 8 7



♠ A 10 7

♥ Q J 10 9

♦ J 7 4

♣ 10 6 3

♠ 6 5 3

♥ 8 6 4 2

♦ K 6

♣ K J 5 2

Board 18

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 8 6 2
♥ 8 4 3 2
♦ A Q 7 4
♣ 9 5

♠ J 10 5
♥ A 6
♦ J 9 3 2
♣ A 8 6 4

N
W E
 S

♠ A 7 4
♥ K Q J 9 7 5
♦ 8
♣ K Q J

♠ K Q 9 3
♥ 10
♦ K 10 6 5
♣ 10 7 3 2

Board 19

South Deals
E-W Vul

♠ Q J 9 4
♥ 7 5 3
♦ Q 10 9 2
♣ 9 4

♠ K 8 2
♥ A K
♦ A 8 5 3
♣ A Q 8 7



♠ A 10 7
♥ Q J 10 9
♦ J 7 4
♣ 10 6 3

♠ 6 5 3
♥ 8 6 4 2
♦ K 6
♣ K J 5 2

Board 20

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ 8 6 2

♥ 8 4 3 2

♦ A Q 7 4

♣ 9 5

♠ J 10 5

♥ A 6

♦ J 9 3 2

♣ A 8 6 4



♠ A 7 4

♥ K Q J 9 7 5

♦ 8

♣ K Q J

♠ K Q 9 3

♥ 10

♦ K 10 6 5

♣ 10 7 3 2

Board 21

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q J 9 4
♥ 7 5 3
♦ Q 10 9 2
♣ 9 4

♠ K 8 2

♥ A K

♦ A 8 5 3

♣ A Q 8 7



♠ A 10 7

♥ Q J 10 9

♦ J 7 4

♣ 10 6 3

♠ 6 5 3

♥ 8 6 4 2

♦ K 6

♣ K J 5 2

Board 22

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 8 6 2

♥ 8 4 3 2

♦ A Q 7 4

♣ 9 5

♠ J 10 5

♥ A 6

♦ J 9 3 2

♣ A 8 6 4



♠ A 7 4

♥ K Q J 9 7 5

♦ 8

♣ K Q J

♠ K Q 9 3

♥ 10

♦ K 10 6 5

♣ 10 7 3 2

Board 23

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q J 9 4

♥ 7 5 3

♦ Q 10 9 2

♣ 9 4

♠ K 8 2

♥ A K

♦ A 8 5 3

♣ A Q 8 7



♠ A 10 7

♥ Q J 10 9

♦ J 7 4

♣ 10 6 3

♠ 6 5 3

♥ 8 6 4 2

♦ K 6

♣ K J 5 2

Board 24

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 6 2
♥ 8 4 3 2
♦ A Q 7 4
♣ 9 5

♠ J 10 5

♥ A 6

♦ J 9 3 2

♣ A 8 6 4



♠ A 7 4

♥ K Q J 9 7 5

♦ 8

♣ K Q J

♠ K Q 9 3

♥ 10

♦ K 10 6 5

♣ 10 7 3 2

Board 25

North Deals
E-W Vul

♠ Q J 9 4
♥ 7 5 3
♦ Q 10 9 2
♣ 9 4

♠ K 8 2
♥ A K
♦ A 8 5 3
♣ A Q 8 7



♠ A 10 7
♥ Q J 10 9
♦ J 7 4
♣ 10 6 3

♠ 6 5 3
♥ 8 6 4 2
♦ K 6
♣ K J 5 2

Board 26

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ 8 6 2

♥ 8 4 3 2

♦ A Q 7 4

♣ 9 5

♠ J 10 5

♥ A 6

♦ J 9 3 2

♣ A 8 6 4



♠ A 7 4

♥ K Q J 9 7 5

♦ 8

♣ K Q J

♠ K Q 9 3

♥ 10

♦ K 10 6 5

♣ 10 7 3 2

Board 27

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 9 4
♥ 7 5 3
♦ Q 10 9 2
♣ 9 4

♠ K 8 2

♥ A K

♦ A 8 5 3

♣ A Q 8 7



♠ A 10 7

♥ Q J 10 9

♦ J 7 4

♣ 10 6 3

♠ 6 5 3

♥ 8 6 4 2

♦ K 6

♣ K J 5 2

Board 28

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 8 6 2
♥ 8 4 3 2
♦ A Q 7 4
♣ 9 5

♠ J 10 5

♥ A 6

♦ J 9 3 2

♣ A 8 6 4



♠ A 7 4

♥ K Q J 9 7 5

♦ 8

♣ K Q J

♠ K Q 9 3

♥ 10

♦ K 10 6 5

♣ 10 7 3 2

Board 29

North Deals
Both Vul

♠ Q J 9 4
♥ 7 5 3
♦ Q 10 9 2
♣ 9 4

♠ K 8 2
♥ A K
♦ A 8 5 3
♣ A Q 8 7



♠ A 10 7
♥ Q J 10 9
♦ J 7 4
♣ 10 6 3

♠ 6 5 3
♥ 8 6 4 2
♦ K 6
♣ K J 5 2

Board 30

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 6 2
♥ 8 4 3 2
♦ A Q 7 4
♣ 9 5

♠ J 10 5

♥ A 6

♦ J 9 3 2

♣ A 8 6 4



♠ A 7 4

♥ K Q J 9 7 5

♦ 8

♣ K Q J

♠ K Q 9 3

♥ 10

♦ K 10 6 5

♣ 10 7 3 2

Board 31

South Deals
N-S Vul

♠ Q J 9 4
♥ 7 5 3
♦ Q 10 9 2
♣ 9 4

♠ K 8 2
♥ A K
♦ A 8 5 3
♣ A Q 8 7



♠ A 10 7
♥ Q J 10 9
♦ J 7 4
♣ 10 6 3

♠ 6 5 3
♥ 8 6 4 2
♦ K 6
♣ K J 5 2

Board 32

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 8 6 2
♥ 8 4 3 2
♦ A Q 7 4
♣ 9 5

♠ J 10 5

♥ A 6

♦ J 9 3 2

♣ A 8 6 4



♠ A 7 4

♥ K Q J 9 7 5

♦ 8

♣ K Q J

♠ K Q 9 3

♥ 10

♦ K 10 6 5

♣ 10 7 3 2

Board 33

North Deals
None Vul

♠ Q J 9 4
♥ 7 5 3
♦ Q 10 9 2
♣ 9 4

♠ K 8 2
♥ A K
♦ A 8 5 3
♣ A Q 8 7



♠ A 10 7
♥ Q J 10 9
♦ J 7 4
♣ 10 6 3

♠ 6 5 3
♥ 8 6 4 2
♦ K 6
♣ K J 5 2

Board 34

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 8 6 2
♥ 8 4 3 2
♦ A Q 7 4
♣ 9 5

♠ J 10 5

♥ A 6

♦ J 9 3 2

♣ A 8 6 4



♠ A 7 4

♥ K Q J 9 7 5

♦ 8

♣ K Q J

♠ K Q 9 3

♥ 10

♦ K 10 6 5

♣ 10 7 3 2

Board 35

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q J 9 4
♥ 7 5 3
♦ Q 10 9 2
♣ 9 4

♠ K 8 2
♥ A K
♦ A 8 5 3
♣ A Q 8 7



♠ A 10 7
♥ Q J 10 9
♦ J 7 4
♣ 10 6 3

♠ 6 5 3
♥ 8 6 4 2
♦ K 6
♣ K J 5 2

Board 36

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ 8 6 2

♥ 8 4 3 2

♦ A Q 7 4

♣ 9 5

♠ J 10 5

♥ A 6

♦ J 9 3 2

♣ A 8 6 4



♠ A 7 4

♥ K Q J 9 7 5

♦ 8

♣ K Q J

♠ K Q 9 3

♥ 10

♦ K 10 6 5

♣ 10 7 3 2